COVER STORY

VISION 2025

2025 already! The number will come as a shock to the many among us for whom the dawn of the millennium seems like only yesterday. Remember Y2K? But although 25 years have passed, and even millennials must be all grown up, no one is handing them the keys just yet: the world is still run by people from the 20th century, and many of the challenges it faces seem rooted in the past.

This issue itself is the latest iteration of a comforting tradition, in which we invite a distinguished panel of experts to gaze into the year ahead for India and the world. They usually have half an eye on the receding chaos in the rearview mirror but an optimistic outlook on the year ahead. Perhaps it's just the Trump effect, but this year's essays seem braced for more chaos ahead, particularly in the geopolitical realm. But as one of our distinguished soothsayers suggests, the lack of a 'world order' has historically been the rule, not the exception—so perhaps there is order in disorder.

We can take comfort in this. Chances are, India and Indians will fare better than most in a world of increased turbulence—we have a reputation for placid progress through adversity. Several of the essays here express a quiet faith in the marriage of technology and governance as the answer to our country's daunting challenges. Think of it as some cheerful sobriety to set the tone for a happier new year. ■

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